*Evidence · Canvas · Series*

# word-cloud

Spiral-packed word cloud — items sized by weight.

# Weight is meaning in a word cloud.




SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

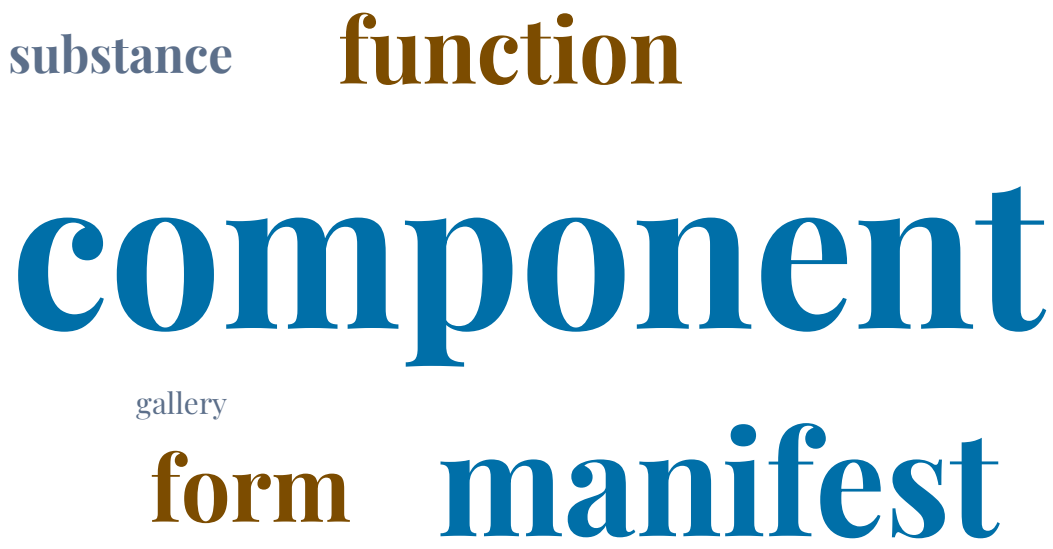
A

A

a

less

# constellation scatters the words like stars.




SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

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less

# dense packs the cloud tight.




SIZE = FREQUENCY

more

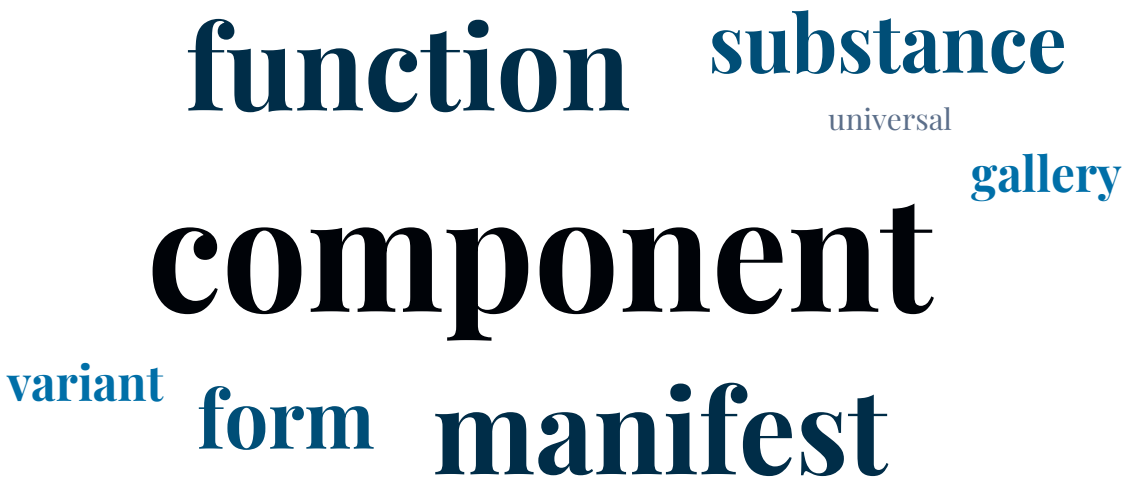
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# spectrum colors the words along a scale.




SIZE = FREQUENCY

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# focal crowns one word the center.




SIZE = FREQUENCY

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# Stress test — 20 terms, raw frequency counts, 512 down to 5.




SIZE = FREQUENCY

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# Weight is meaning in a word cloud.




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# When NOT to reach for word-cloud.

### Precise comparisons

If the audience needs to know that 'manifest' is 1.6× 'function', the spiral packing actively misleads. Use `progress` or a bar chart where the eye can compare lengths directly.

### Two or three words

A three-word cloud is a list with extra steps. Use `stats` for a metric row or `big-number` for a single weighted headline.

### Multi-word phrases

Each li should be a single token. Multi-word phrases blow out the layout and crowd the spiral; if your data is phrases, normalize to keywords first or use `quote` for verbatim text.

*Related components*

# See also.

`progress` — the weights need precise visual comparison

`stats` — the headline metrics are independent numbers, not a corpus

`piechart` — the items are parts of a whole, not free-form themes

`quote` — the verbatim language matters more than the frequency

`list` — single-line takeaways — the `takeaway` variant